

RULES AND REGULATIONS

1. Eligibility

Participation is open to Diploma and Undergraduate students from Public (IPTA) and Private (IPTS) Higher Education Institutions in Malaysia. All participants must be Malaysian citizens.

2. Team Composition

Each team must consist of FOUR (4) students from the same university and ONE (1) supervising lecturer.

3. Team Member Changes

No team changes are allowed after the registration deadline unless approved by the organising committee under exceptional circumstances.

4. Supervisor Role

The supervising lecturer is expected to provide guidance and advisory support only, and not to be directly involved in the product development.

5. Registration & Fees

Registration must be completed through the official MDIT x DD 2025 portal. Each team is required to pay a non-refundable RM150 entry fee.

6. Official Receipt and Claim Procedures

The official receipt will be issued throughout the competition. It may be used by teams to claim the registration fee from their universities, subject to their internal procedures. Participants must manage their own claims with their universities, as the organisers will not provide assistance or take any responsibility.

7. Mandatory WhatsApp Group Participation

Upon confirmation of registration, participants must join the official WhatsApp group 'PARTICIPANTS MDIT x DD 2025' using the provided link. All official announcements and updates will be made through this group.

8. Mandatory Attendance

All participants are required to be present and actively involved in every session organised throughout the competition.

9. Development Timeline

All projects must be completed within the competition's specified timeframe. Late submissions will not be accepted or evaluated.

10. Data Sources

Participants must use open and publicly accessible datasets. The use of fabricated, simulated, or fictional data is strictly prohibited. All data must be authentic, reliable, and sourced from credible platforms. Recommended data sources include (but are not limited to):

- OpenDOSM (Department of Statistics Malaysia)
- eStatistik
- data.gov.my (Malaysian Government Open Data Portal)
- World Bank Open Data
- Monthly Highlights and Statistics Dataset (Bank Negara Malaysia)
- UN Data

Extra marks will be awarded for use of Malaysian official data (e.g., OpenDOSM, eStatistik, StatsDW IDL), subject to judging criteria.

11. Tools & Equipment

Participants may use any hardware and software of their choice, but must provide and use their own ICT equipment throughout the competition.

12. Originality and Use of Third-Party Materials

All submitted work must be the original work of the team. Teams may use third-party libraries, frameworks, pre-trained models, and openly licensed datasets as long as they clearly cite and list each external resource in the Project Report and reproducibility package, and also document how those resources were used and integrated. Submissions that copy, plagiarise, or otherwise use proprietary intellectual property without licence or attribution will be disqualified.

13. Required Submissions

Each team must submit:

- a) A dashboard in PDF containing the source file (eg., .pbix, .xslm, etc.)
- b) A recorded presentation video
- c) A project report using the template provided by the organisers

14. Final Submission

Once submitted, no changes or resubmissions are allowed. The final version will be evaluated as is.

15. Dashboard Accessibility

The final product must be delivered in dashboard form and must remain accessible until the evaluation process is complete.

16. Ethical Data Use

Participants must not use any personally identifiable or confidential data without permission. Plagiarism or using copied content (e.g., dashboards) will result in disqualification.

17. Intellectual Property Rights

Participants retain full ownership of their projects. However, the organisers reserve non-exclusive rights to showcase, publish, or exhibit the project for promotional or educational use, with proper credit to the team.

18. Personal Data Protection

All personal data shared with the organisers will be securely stored and used only according to competition rules, unless explicit consent is given for other purposes.

19. Prohibition of Harmful Software

Submissions must be free from harmful elements such as viruses, trojans, spyware, or any code that could damage or disrupt systems.

20. Inappropriate Content Prohibited

Submissions containing offensive, violent, defamatory, or insulting content especially against the organisers or any unauthorized copyrighted material will be disqualified.

21. Violation of Rules

The organisers reserve the right to disqualify or cancel any team's entry if rules or submission requirements are violated.

22. Liability Disclaimer

The organisers will not be held responsible for any incidents, health issues, damages, or losses incurred during participation.

23. Final Decision by Judges

All decisions by the judging panel, including the selection of winners, are final and cannot be appealed.

24. E-Certificate Eligibility

E-certificates of participation will be issued only to participants who submit their final products within the deadline. Certificates will be emailed after the competition ends.

MDIT X DD 2025 JUDGING CRITERIA

Each team will be evaluated by a panel of expert judges. Scoring will be based on the following key criteria.

Main Evaluation Criteria

Part A: Project Content (60%)

- Data Selection
- Introduction
- Literature Review
- Methodology & Data Analysis
- Findings & Results
- Conclusion
- Originality & Commercial Value

Part B: Project Presentation (40%)

- Quality of Presentation
- Subject Knowledge
- Ability to Answer Questions
- Teamwork & Collaboration
- Creativity & Innovation
- Time Management

Special Awards Categories

1. Pitching Excellence Award (Individual)

Awarded to the individual who delivers the most effective and engaging presentation, demonstrating clarity, confidence, good structure, strong audience connection, and appropriate pacing.

2. Critical Thinking & Defence Award (Team)

Recognises the team that shows excellent knowledge of their project, works well together, responds confidently to questions, handles feedback positively, and defends their ideas with strong logic and reasoning.

3. Innovation Excellence Award (Team)

Honours the team that showcases the most original and innovative ideas, with clear data organisation, impactful visual design, practical applications, and potential for scalability.